A Vision of the Harvest

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Manuscript excerpt

Preface

A Vision of the Harvest

The title of this work was born out of an experience the Lord gave me several years ago—an experience that has never left me.

I was playing the drums during a church service in Fort Worth, Texas, when something unexpected unfolded in my spirit. I am not one given to hype or glorifying the unusual, but the Lord impressed upon me the importance of remembering what He reveals. As the service concluded, I remained seated behind the drums, looking out over the congregation. In my mind's eye, I suddenly saw the people before me not merely as individuals in a room, but as a vast field—ripe and ready for harvest.

The Lord invited me to step down from my vantage point and walk with Him into the field. As we moved together, He began revealing truths about the harvest—simple in concept, yet profound in meaning. He showed me stalks of corn that were well-pollinated and full, some with five or six ears, mature and ready to be gathered. Others were only partially grown, bearing just two or three ears. Some had grown too closely together, stunted and unpollinated. I saw stalks with no ears at all—wilted, dying in the field. Yet right beside them were others standing strong and healthy.

As these images unfolded, understanding followed. The field, the Lord showed me, is humanity upon the earth. For thousands of years God has been planting, watering, and reaping the souls of men and women. From the beginning of time, His grace has worked tirelessly to redeem mankind. Faith, I came to understand, is the avenue through which God works upon the heart.

Some are growing.
Some are wounded.
Some are dying.
Some are healthy.
Some are recovering.

Yet all remain under God's sovereign care and command.

The laborers are those of us who work in the field. As Scripture declares, "Paul planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase" (1 Corinthians 3:6). We are called to plant and to water—to sow seeds of faith and to tend what God has entrusted to us—while always remembering that the harvest itself belongs to the Lord.

This realization raised sobering questions in my heart:
How do we do the work?
What should we say?
Why is fulfilling the Great Commission so vital?

These are the questions I seek to address in the pages that follow.

Over more than three decades of serving in various forms of outreach, the Lord has placed within me a growing burden for His harvest. That burden has compelled me not only to labor, but to teach—to help equip others who desire to be used of God. The results are always in His hands; I offer only what He has taught me, trusting Him to give the increase.

My prayer is this: that the words of this devotional would shape your heart and sharpen your vision. That you would receive wisdom, grow in understanding, and walk with renewed purpose. May your love for God deepen, your compassion for souls increase, and your clarity concerning His work be strengthened.

And most of all, may your time be filled with the joy and honor of laboring in the Kingdom of God.

Sincerely,
John P. Kennon

A VISION OF THE HARVEST

This book is a 52-week devotional journey, written to form that understanding over time—converting evangelism from an occasional event into a lived, daily lifestyle. It is not designed to create busyness, but to shape believers who live sent, think intentionally, and obey faithfully in ordinary life.

A Vision of the Harvest

God has always been a God of harvest.

From the opening pages of Scripture to the final invitation of Revelation, His desire has never wavered—that none should perish, but that all should come to repentance (2 Peter 3:9). Revival has never begun with programs, momentum, or emotional intensity. It has always begun with God’s burden for lost souls.